

INDIA MAHARASHTRA DISTRICT RATNAGIRI

KILOMETRES
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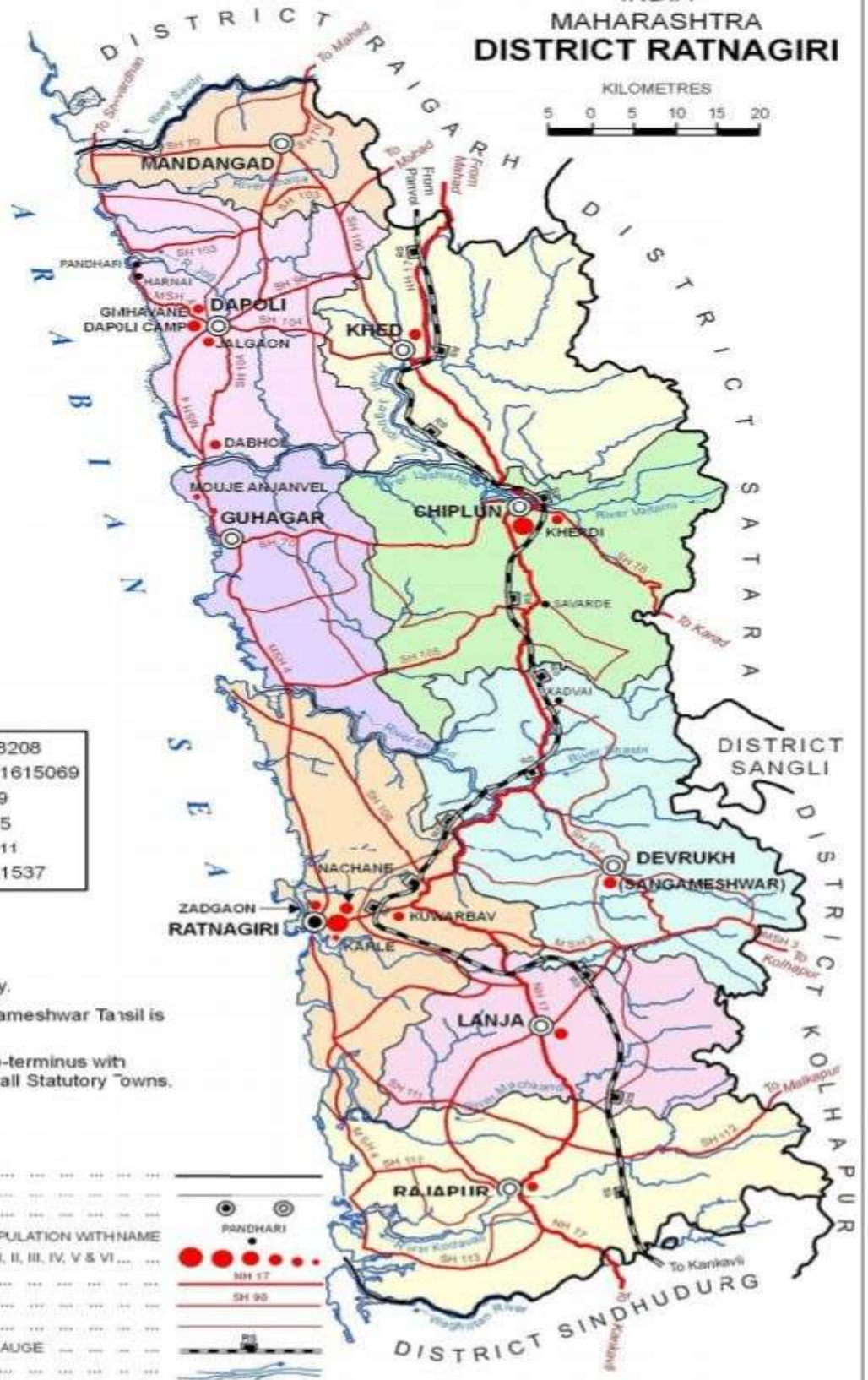
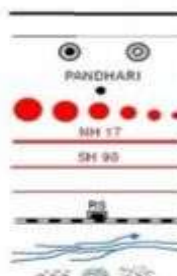
Area in km ²	: 8208
Population	: 1615069
No. of Tahsils	: 9
No. of Statutory Towns	: 5
No. of Census Towns	: 11
No. of Villages	: 1537

MSH : Major State Highway.

The Headquarters of Sangameshwar Tahsil is at Devrukh.

C. D. Block Boundary is Co-terminus with Tahsil Boundary Excluding all Statutory Towns.

BOUNDARY, DISTRICT	---
" TAHSIL	---
HEADQUARTERS : DISTRICT, TAHSIL	---
VILLAGES HAVING 5000 AND ABOVE POPULATION WITH NAME	---
URBAN AREA WITH POPULATION SIZE : I, II, III, IV, V & VI	---
NATIONAL HIGHWAY	---
STATE HIGHWAY	---
IMPORTANT METALLED ROAD	---
RAILWAY LINE WITH STATION, BROAD GAUGE	---
RIVER AND STREAM	---
MUD, ROCK AND SAND	---



Religious and Tourist Sites - Ratnagiri District

15. Religious and Tourist Sites

To promote tourism development, a Government Resolution issued by the Home Department on 8 November 1996 decided to develop many well-known pilgrimage sites, historical, cultural, and scenic locations across the urban and rural areas of the state for tourism purposes. Accordingly, such sites were classified into three categories — “A”, “B”, and “C”. Based on this classification, the tourist sites currently existing in Ratnagiri district, category-wise, are as follows.

Category	Taluka	Name of Tourist Site	Total
A	Ratnagiri	Thiba Palace, Pavas, Ganpatipule	03
	Lanja	Machal	01
	Total Category A		00
B	Dapoli	Panhale	01
	Guhagar	Velneswar	01
	Total Category B		06
C	Mandangad	Devacha Dongar, Mandangad Fort, Bankot Fort, Ambadve, Kelshi, Pajpandhari, Anjarla, Panhaledurg Fort, Palgad, Suvarnadurg (Harne) Fort, Kanakdurg, Fattegad, Goa Fort, Unhavare, Murud, caves at Dapoli,	16

Category	Taluka	Name of Tourist Site	Total
		Karde, Ladghar, Dabhol village, Vanand village	
	Khed	Chorvane, Kartel, Wadibeldar, Songaon, Phurus, Mahipatgad, Sumargad, Rasalgad, Paldurg Fort, Raghuvir Ghat, caves at Khed, Shri Kalkai Temple at Bharne, Nirbaji Waterfall area near Kandoshi village	13
	Chiplun	Anari, Dalvatane, Gandhareshwar, Adre, Govalkotgad, Kolkewadi Fort, Bhairavgad, Parshuram Temple, Derwan, Savatsada, the historic Chiplun Sharadadevi Temple at Mauje Turambav, Shri Kulswamibhavani Waghjai Devsthan at Terav, Shri Devi Karanjeshwari Temple area at Govalkot, Pandava-era caves / Pir Baba Dargah	14
	Guhagar	Guhagar, Hedvi, Anjanvel Fort, Vijaygad, Modka Agar, Durgadevi Temple area at Budhal, Kotluk, Varveli, Sakhri Agar	10
	Sangameshwar	Talvade Tikaleshwar, Bhavnagad,	07

Category	Taluka	Name of Tourist Site	Total
		Prachitgad, Mahipatgad, Sangameshwar Kasba area, Marleshwar, Kadvai	
	Lanja	Math, Satavali Gadhi, Rani Lakshmibai memorial at Mauje Kot, Ganguchi Baul near Bare Zorewadi	04
	Ratnagiri	Mandavi, Hatis, Ratnagiri city, Ratnadurg Fort, Jaigad, Purnagad, Malgund, Nirul, Ratnagiri Nivali Waterfall, Bhate beach, Devi Kalika Temple area and beach at Kalbadevi, Shil Dam, Panwal Waterfall, Rantale near Gavakhadi area, Dhopeswar, Chunakolvan, Ambolgad, Yashwantgad, Rajapur Gadhi, Ganga Tirth and hot water spring at Rajapur, rock art (petroglyphs) in Rajapur taluka, Mauje Saundal, Ozar Waterfall at Ghagwadi	14
	Rajapur	Ranatale, Bhopeswar, Chunakolvan, Ambolgad, Yashwantgad, Rajapur Gadhi, Ganga Tirtha and	09

Category	Taluka	Name of Tourist Site	Total
		hot water spring at Rajapur, Kartalshilpa (rock art) of Rajapur taluka, Mauje Saundal, Ozar Waterfall near Ghagwadi	
	Total Category C		91
	Grand Total (A+B+C)		97

Development of “A” and “B” category tourist sites is carried out from budgetary provisions received from the State Government. Sites of local importance are included in Category “C” with the approval of the District Planning Committee, and their development is carried out using funds available under the District Annual Plan.

Some of the important tourist sites in Ratnagiri district are as follows:

1) Ganpatipule: Located about 40 km from Ratnagiri, Ganpatipule is known as an awakened (jagrut) shrine of Lord Ganpati. Due to its vast beach and various tourist amenities, it attracts a large number of devotees and tourists. Malgund, the birthplace of poet Keshavsut, is located near Ganpatipule, where a memorial to the poet has been built.

2) Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar Memorial at Ambadve: Ambadve is the ancestral village of Bharat Ratna Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar, architect of the Indian Constitution. It is located 13 km from Mandangad. His ancestral home has been converted into a memorial, and a National Memorial to Dr. Ambedkar is being built here.

3) Birthplace of Lokmanya Tilak: The house where Lokmanya Tilak was born is located in Ratnagiri city itself. This birthplace has been preserved by the government as a National Memorial. While his father worked as a teacher, the family lived on rent in the

mansion of Smt. Indirabai Gore in Tilak Ali. Lokmanya Tilak was born there on 23 July 1856, and the family lived there from 1856 to 1866.

4) Thiba Palace: Thiba Palace is a royal residence in Ratnagiri city, built by the British. In 1885, the British arrested King Thibaw of Burma and kept him under house arrest at this palace. The palace is a three-storey structure with a pagoda-style sloping roof.

5) Patitpavan Mandir: An important site in the struggle against untouchability and for social equality, Patitpavan Mandir is located in Ratnagiri city. It was built by Veer Savarkar with the cooperation of Bhagoji Sheth Keer of Ratnagiri. Built in 1929 and opened to the then “untouchable” community, it is recorded as the first temple in the country where members of upper castes and the then-untouchable community dined together — an example of Ratnagiri’s progressive spirit.

6) Swami Swarupanand Ashram: The ashram of Swami Swarupanand is located at Pavas, just 15 km from Ratnagiri. The 29 caves at Panhale Kaji nearby are also a tourist attraction.

7) Kasba Sangameshwar: Situated at the confluence of the Shastri and Sonavi rivers on the Mumbai-Goa highway, Sangameshwar’s Kasba area holds great historical and mythological significance. Legend holds that the Pandavas built around 360 temples in this area, of which the Karneshwar Temple is a prominent one. This ancient Hemadpanthi-style temple, built by King Karna of the Chalukya dynasty, hosts a large fair (yatra) on Mahashivratri. Near this temple stands Sardesai’s Wada, where Aurangzeb had Chhatrapati Sambhaji Maharaj arrested along with Kavi Kalash and subjected them to brutal torture and execution. Sambhaji Maharaj was martyred here, and a statue and memorial to him have been erected at this site.

8) Shri Ganpati Temple at Hedvi: About 18 km from Guhagar, the village of Hedvi has a famous Peshwa-era Shri Ganpati temple. The idol here is known as “Shri Dashbhuj Lakshmi Ganesh.” A large fair is held here on Maghi Chaturthi.

9) Mahakali Temple at Adivare and Rajapur's Ganga: About 30 km from Rajapur, the village of Adivare has an ancient Shri Mahakali temple. During the rule of the Shilahara kings, Adivare was a flourishing marketplace. A large fair is held here during Navratri. The Ganga at Rajapur, which appears once every three years in Rajapur taluka, is also famous and this site is referred to as Ganga Tirth. Nearby is Unhale, known for its hot water springs. Close to Rajapur is also the ancient Dhutpapeshwar temple.

10) Shri Kshetra Parshuram Temple: The ancient temple of Parshuram, regarded as the sixth incarnation of Vishnu, is located 12 km from Chiplun. On the Mumbai-Goa highway, just before Chiplun, a road on the left leads up the hill to the temple. The temple's inner sanctum houses idols of Brahma, Vishnu, and Mahesh, while a second sanctum contains Shri Parshuram's bed, upon which his sacred footwear (paduka) is placed. Beside the temple is Bangaga Lake, said to have been created when Parshuram struck the ground with an arrow.

11) Shri Kshetra Marleshwar: Located 18 km from Devrukh in Sangameshwar taluka, nestled amid the scenic valleys of the Sahyadri range, Shri Kshetra Marleshwar is a shrine dedicated to Lord Shankar (Shiva). The shrine sits within a cave reached by winding around the mountain up to a high cliff. A large fair is held here on Makar Sankranti. There is also a large waterfall on the hill, beneath which devotees gather in large numbers to bathe. The beauty of the waterfalls cascading down the mountain during the monsoon is beyond description, and walking along the path amid the lush greenery and birdsong, one hardly feels tired.

12) Shri Kshetra Velneshwar: The famous Mahadev Temple at Velneshwar has an ancient heritage of 1,200 years. Velneshwar is blessed with a clean and safe beach.